

tion prompt. When you confirm that action, the program in question is granted the admin-level rights and privileges to make the necessary changes.

2. You are logged in as standard user but know the admin password: the scenario here is similar to the one above. The difference here is that your actual account does not belong in the Local administrator's group, and you are not allowed to make any changes to the system by default. When a program requires system access, you will be prompted to supply the administrator password—upon success, the program would be able to run as needed; else, if you do not have the required access rights, that is, you are not an administrator, you will not be able to make any changes at the system level. A standard user is not completely powerless to make changes to the system, however, which brings us to our next point:
3. You are a standard user without knowledge of the admin password. In this case you are granted some rights by Vista, mostly limited to making changes to your personal files, folders, and settings. You cannot make any system-wide changes and thus neither can any programs run by you.

To get a better idea of what differentiates a standard user from an Administrator under Vista, take a look at the table on the opposite page:

6.1.1 Changes Introduced By UAC

Since UAC implies that even an Administrator doesn't have access to system resources by default, some older programs from Windows XP days might have problems running under Vista. To better understand why, let's quickly take a look at exactly what happens when an admin logs into a Vista system.

Upon login, the system issues a token to the user, which determines just what the user can access—the token defines the privileges and the access rights of the user. Under XP, the system would issue just one such: you were either an admin or a standard user. Vista, though, issues two tokens to an administrator account. The